

Targeted therapy for cervical cancer

Bevacizumab is the main targeted drug used for cervical cancer. The treatment is usually given in combination with chemotherapy drugs.

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What is targeted therapy for cervical cancer?

Targeted therapy uses drugs to find and attack cancer cells. There are many different types of targeted therapy. Each type targets something in or around the cancer cell that is helping it grow and survive.

[Bevacizumab](#) is a targeted therapy treatment sometimes used to treat [cervical cancer](#). It may be used if cervical cancer:

- [is advanced](#)
- has come back after treatment.

It cannot cure the cancer, but it may help to control it for a time.

Bevacizumab works by stopping the cancer from making blood vessels. This means that the cancer does not get the oxygen and nutrients it needs and may shrink or stop growing. The treatment is usually given in combination with [chemotherapy drugs](#).

Bevacizumab is given into a vein as an infusion.

Side effects of targeted therapy for cervical cancer

Side effects of bevacizumab are usually mild to moderate. They can include:

- high blood pressure
- headaches
- [feeling sick](#)
- a [sore mouth](#)
- [tiredness \(fatigue\)](#)
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[diarrhoea](#).

An uncommon but more serious side effect is an area of tissue breaking down in the vagina, bladder or bowel. This can cause a hole, which makes a new opening or [fistula](#) between two parts of the body, such as the vagina and bladder. If you have had [radiotherapy to the pelvis](#), there is a higher risk of this happening with bevacizumab.

Your doctor or nurse can tell you more about possible side effects and how they can be managed.

About our information

References



Below is a sample of the sources used in our cervical cancer, cervical screening and CIN information. If you would like more information about the sources we use, please contact us at canцерinformationteam@macmillan.org.uk

GOV.UK. Cervical screening: programme overview. Updated 18 November 2019. Available from www.gov.uk/guidance/cervical-screening-programme-overview (accessed March 2020).

GOV.UK. Colposcopic diagnosis, treatment and follow up. Updated 5 February 2020. Available from www.gov.uk/government/publications/cervical-screening-programme-and-colposcopy-management/3-colposcopic-diagnosis-treatment-and-follow-up (accessed April 2020).

Marth C, Landoni F, Mahner S, et al. Cervical cancer: ESMO clinical practice guidelines. *Annals of Oncology*, 2017; 28, suppl 4, iv72–iv83. Available from <https://www.esmo.org/guidelines/esmo-clinical-practice-guideline-cervical-cancer> (accessed October 2020).

Reed N, Balega J, Barwick T, et al. British Gynaecological Cancer Society (BGCS) cervical cancer guidelines: recommendations for practice. 2020. Available from www.bgcs.org.uk/wp-content/uploads/2020/05/FINAL-Cx-Ca-Version-for-submission.pdf (accessed October 2020).

Reviewers



This information has been written, revised and edited by Macmillan Cancer Support's Cancer Information Development team. It has been reviewed by expert medical and health professionals and people living with cancer. It has been approved by Senior Medical Editor, [Professor Nick Reed](#), Consultant Clinical Oncologist.

Our cancer information has been awarded the [PIF TICK](#). Created by the Patient Information Forum, this quality mark shows we meet PIF's 10 criteria for trustworthy health information.

The language we use

We want everyone affected by cancer to feel our information is written for them.

We want our information to be as clear as possible. To do this, we try to:

- use plain English
- explain medical words
- use short sentences
- use illustrations to explain text
- structure the information clearly
- make sure important points are clear.

We use gender-inclusive language and talk to our readers as 'you' so that everyone feels included. Where clinically necessary we use the terms 'men' and 'women' or 'male' and 'female'. For example, we do so when talking about parts of the body or mentioning statistics or research about who is affected.

You can read more about how we produce our information [here](#).

Date reviewed

Reviewed: 01 April 2021 | Next review: 01 April 2024

⚠ This content is currently being reviewed. New information will be coming soon.

Our cancer information meets the [PIF TICK](#) quality mark.

This means it is easy to use, up-to-date and based on the latest evidence. Learn more about [how we produce our information](#).

How we can help

Macmillan Support Line

The Macmillan Support Line is a free and confidential service for people living with and affected by cancer. If you need to talk, we'll listen.



Call us free on 0808 808 0000

8am to 8pm, 7 days a week. You can talk to our cancer specialists about anything.



Email the Macmillan Support Line

Email the Macmillan Support Team if you have any questions.

Chat online

Available 8am to 7.45pm, 7 days a week. For confidential, real-time support if you don't want to call.



Online Community

Chat online anonymously to others who understand what you are going through. Our community is available 24/7 and has dedicated forums where you can get advice and ask our experts.



Find cancer support services in your area

What's going on near you? Find out about support groups, where to get information and how to get involved with Macmillan where you live.

Get help